

Expense Approval Workflow

Process Documentation — Finance Operations

Document Owner: Finance Department

Applies To: United States entities (primary) — UAE equivalents noted in brackets

Overview

This workflow outlines the steps required to submit, review, and approve employee expenses in alignment with company policy.

Roles Involved

- **Employee:** Submits expenses with supporting documentation (itemized receipts and pre-approvals if relevant).
- **Line Manager:** Reviews and approves submissions for accuracy and business relevance.
- **Finance Team:** Verifies compliance and processes reimbursement.

Process Steps

1. Employee submits an expense claim with itemized receipts via the expense management system (e.g., Concur, which supports both U.S. and UAE entities; or Expensify/Ramp for U.S.-based teams — Ramp is U.S.-only).
2. Line Manager reviews the claim for accuracy and business relevance.
3. Line Manager approves or rejects the claim in the system.
4. Finance verifies receipts, checks policy compliance, and flags discrepancies if needed.
5. Finance processes reimbursement on the next scheduled bi-weekly payroll or accounts payable (AP) run.

Exceptions

- Missing receipts require written manager justification.
- Claims exceeding USD \$1,000 require Controller or Finance Manager approval. [UAE equivalent: AED 3,700 / Finance Director approval.]

Timeline

Standard processing: 5–7 business days for review and approval; reimbursement is then disbursed on the next scheduled bi-weekly payroll or AP run (typically within 1–2 weeks total), assuming complete documentation and no policy exceptions.

Workflow Diagram

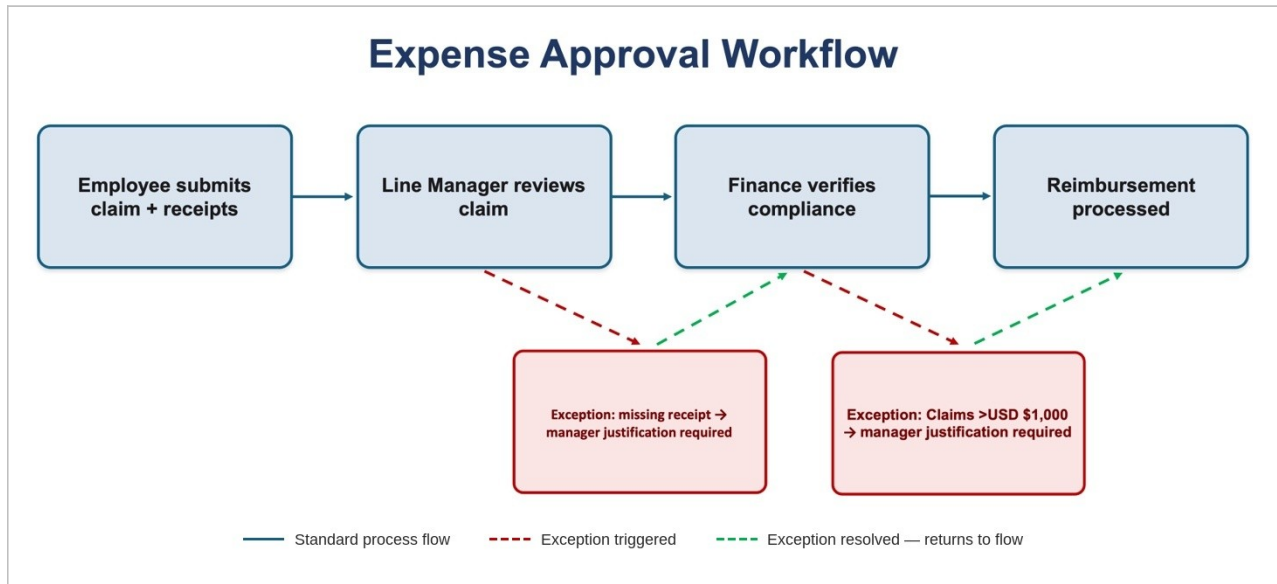


Figure 1. Expense approval workflow, including the exception path.

Expense Submission Screen (Sample)

New Expense Report
Expense Portal

Expense Date 08/10/2026	Category Client Travel — Airfare
Amount (USD) \$482.00	Payment Method Corporate Card ****4471

Business Justification

Receipt

[receipt-08102026.pdf]

Figure 2. Expense submission screen.

Sample Itemized Receipt

SkyLine Airways	
Passenger Receipt — Sample Data	
Passenger	A. Martinez
Confirmation #	SLY-482910
Route	JFK → DXB → JFK
Travel Date	09/02/2026 - 09/06/2026
Fare	\$412.00
Taxes & Fees	\$70.00
Total Charged	\$482.00
Payment Method	Corporate Card ****4471

This is a fabricated sample receipt for portfolio use only.

Figure 3. Fabricated sample receipt for illustration only.